EAST BAY PERMACULTURE GUILD · HACK FOR SOCIAL IMPACT 2026

# Roots

## Volunteers who come back.

Reasons that make every hour count, AI that knows your people, and money that funds more volunteer days.

Built on Garden Steward · Demo uses fictional volunteers

THE GUILD’S CHALLENGE

# People come once. Then life gets in the way.

**8 of 35**

people in our demo community came once and have not been back. A garden needs the same hands every month.

“…welcome new members, understand how they want to participate, and turn event details into outreach ready for volunteer review.”

Affordable, easy to maintain, and personal.

Quote: the Guild’s written challenge. Demo figures use fictional volunteers.

# Roots gives people three reasons to stay.

1 · HOURS THAT COUNT

## 12

volunteers could gain a benefit by coming back: school hours, FFA, college credit, CalFresh.

2 · A PERSONAL NUDGE

## AI + you

A Garden Steward sign-up learns what people want. Roots drafts each SMS; a coordinator sends it.

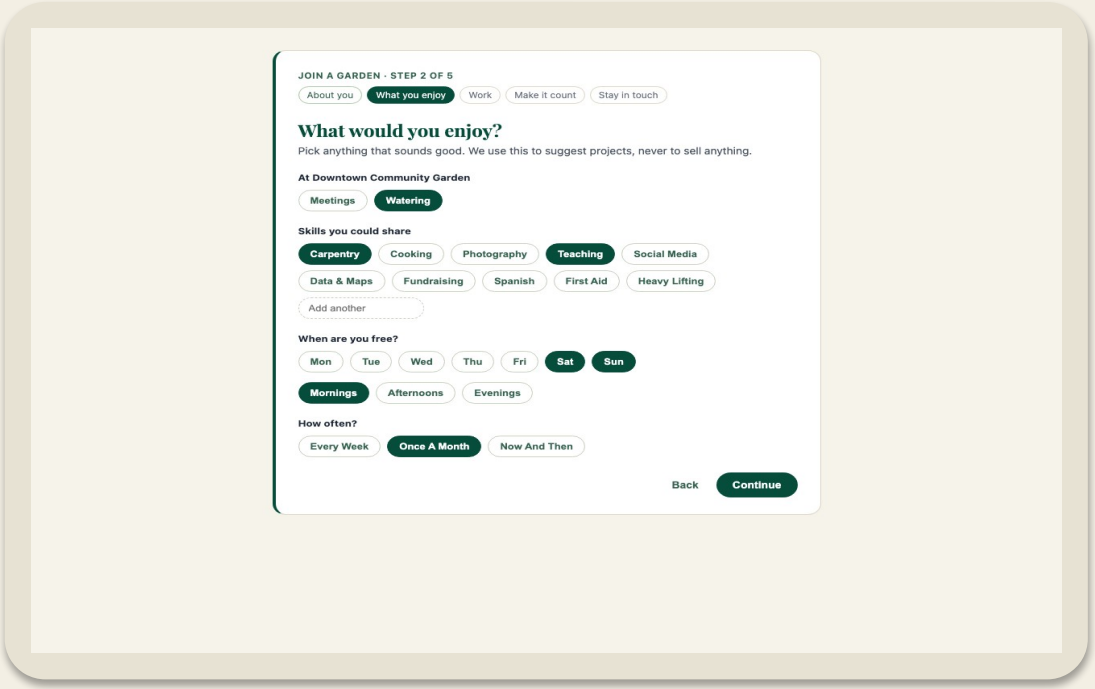
3 · MONEY FOR THE GARDEN

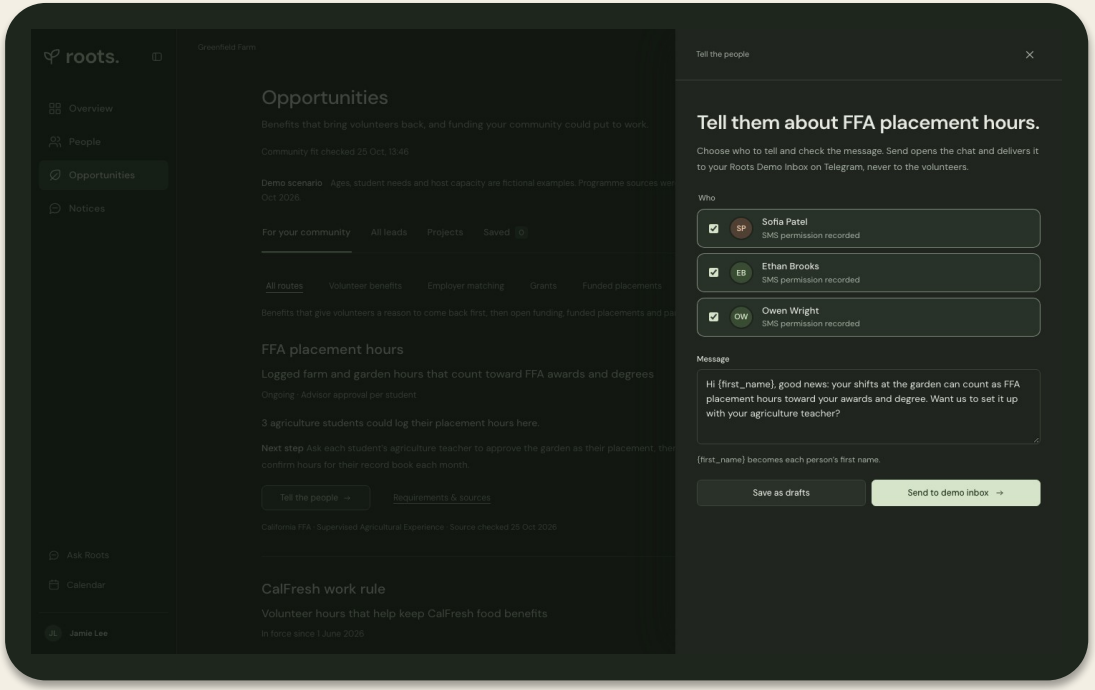
## $25/hr

from Microsoft for 3 regulars' hours, plus a $2.5k–$10k grant that closes 2 November.

Benefits → return visits → logged hours → funding → more volunteer days.

# Know them. Reach them.




**Sign-up in Garden Steward:** interests, availability, work, and whether their hours could count.

**Tell the people:** Roots writes the SMS. Nothing goes out until a person sends it.

Demo uses fictional people. SMS is not connected yet; demo messages go to a Telegram demo inbox.

ROOTS

# Every hour should count for something.

Let’s pilot it at the Guild’s next monthly work day.

Built into Garden Steward · a person approves every message · costs cents